

Google positioned the Pixel C as the Android equivalent of the iPad Pro and designed it quite heavily around its companion keyboard – a tiny keyboard with surprisingly deep travel but with narrow chiclet style keys that attach to the Pixel C via strong magnets. The Nvidia Tegra X1 also had enough processing grunt to pull off most light office tasks but in sheer irony to the Nexus 9, this time, the software was the weak point. While Android is technically capable of doing productivity work, it's an extremely frustrating and suboptimal way compared to Windows or even ChromeOS. The same thing could be said of the iPad Pro as well but it's even more evident on the Pixel C. While it has received decent reviews critically, almost everyone noted that it was a tough thing to be able to recommend the Pixel C to someone else when a different product could accomplish the same tasks much better. And the price didn't help things. \$499 for the tablet plus another \$149 for the keyboard leaves the



The Companion Keyboard

Pixel C at the same price of the starting Microsoft Surface Pro, which while is the same convertible tablet with a keyboard idea, is also a full-fledged Windows PC with all the standard Windows tools available to it. (Did we mention that both of them were the same weight as well?) And looking at it from just a purely tablet viewpoint, competitors in the same price range like the Galaxy Tab S2 were thinner, lighter and had a much better AMOLED display thereby quashing the Pixel's dreams of being a purely handheld multimedia consumption device.

So while the Pixel C might not have been the success that Google has hoped for, it does pave the way for a better future. Perhaps if Android progresses to the point where doing productivity tasks becomes more enjoyable and less of a chore, perhaps laplets like the next Pixel tablet might be a truly groundbreaking device. Until then, the Pixel C is just a proof of concept device that while is pretty and powerful, is not just cut out for the mainstream yet. **d**